

Using The Mouse More Effectively

To select a line of text or a paragraph, you probably move the mouse pointer over the entire line or paragraph you want to select while keeping the left mouse button held down. There's a much easier way to do this, which works with many different software. Move the mouse pointer to the left of the line or paragraph until the cursor changes from the "I" looking stick to the standard arrow cursor. Click once to select the current line of text, twice to select the current paragraph, or three times to select the entire document.

Sorting Names

Say you have a list of names in a document, and need to sort them. You can accomplish this task using tables, but if you don't want to mess with tables, here's the alternative approach.

First make sure the names in your document are arranged so there is only one person per paragraph. Select all the paragraphs that contain names. Choose the Sort option from the Table menu. Word displays the Sort Text dialog box. Click Options. Word displays the Sort Options dialog box. Select Other.

Erase the contents of the box to the right of Other, replacing it with a single space. Word will now know that you want to consider spaces as the dividing point between the sort fields. Click OK to close the Sort Options dialog box. Then, use the Sort By drop-down lists to specify the word by which you want to sort. For instance, if you want to sort by last name—which is the word after the first space—you should choose "Word 2" in the Sort By drop-down list. Click OK, and your names will be sorted.

Table-To-Text

There will be many occasions when you want to convert a table to text. To do this, first select the entire table. Choose Convert from the Table menu, then chose Table to Text from the resulting sub-menu. Word displays the Convert Table to Text dialog box. Select an appropriate character for Word to use to separate the columns of text. Click OK.

Large Icons In Word

The icons in the Word toolbar—such as the disk icon for Save—may be too small for you, or perhaps you just like large icons. You can make them bigger. Under Tools, click Customize.

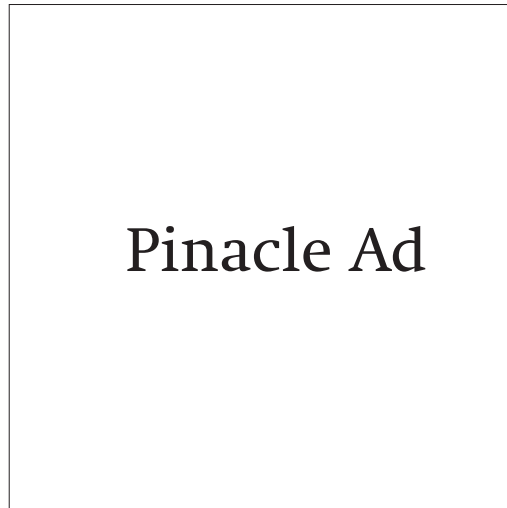
When the Customize dialog box appears, choose Options and check Large Icons. The toolbar icons will instantly get big!



Get bigger icons for Word

Adjusting Column Width

If you have a table in your document, you may find that your overall table width is the way you want it, but the columns within the table



are not just right. As an example, you may want the columns to be the same width as each other—this without disturbing the overall width of the table. To achieve this, select the table and then choose Table > AutoFit > Distribute Columns Evenly. Done!

Freeze Tables

If you don't want your table to readjust itself to fit whatever you put in it, Word allows you to freeze a table's layout. For instance, you might want the cells to be a certain size, and never change even when you place a large amount of data in the cell. The first step is to adjust the column width so that the columns in your table are the way you want them. Then, choose Table Properties from the Table menu. Word displays the Table Properties dialog box. Make sure the Row tab is selected. Select the Specify Height checkbox, and enter a height for the rows. Use the "Row Height Is" drop-down to choose Exactly. Now, go to the Table tab. Click Options. Word will display the Table Options dialog box. Clear the "Automatically Resize to Fit Contents" box. Click OK to close the

Table Options dialog box, then click OK to close the Table Properties dialog box.

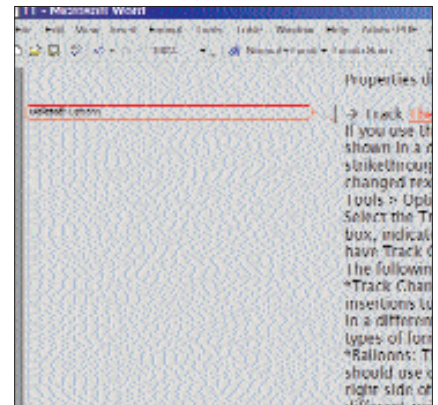
Track Changes Options

If you use the Track Changes feature in Word, added text is shown in a different color, and deleted text is shown with a strikethrough. You may want to change how Word shows your changed text. To make your configuration changes, first go to Tools > Options. Word will display the Options dialog box. Select the Track Changes tab. Using the controls in the dialog box, indicate how you want your changes to appear when you have Track Changes turned on. Click OK. The following are some of the options available:

***Track Changes Options:** Here you specify how you want text insertions to appear. They normally appear as underlined text in a different colour, but you can instruct Word to use different types of formatting for the text you add to the document.

***Balloons:** The controls in this area allow you to specify if Word should use change balloons. These balloons appear at the right side of a document and indicate the changes made at different points.

***Changed Lines:** This setting is used to specify how any lines that contain changes should be noted. Normally, Word adds a vertical bar to the outside border of the line.



Use the "Track Changes" feature in Word to track changes in your documents

Deleting Pages In A Document

If you need a quick way to delete a page in your document, you can use the following macro:

```
Sub Delete_Page()  
ActiveDocument.Bookmarks("\Page").Range.Delete  
End Sub
```

Assign the macro to a toolbar button or a shortcut key (we're assuming you know how to do so), and you can easily delete the current page,